

The FBI Case File

FBI 62-HQ-83894 — UAP Investigations · 1947–1968

Analysis of PURSUE Release 01 · Track D · 20 volumes · 2,638 pages · 153 visual pages · GPT-5.5 review

Personal research project designed by Joe, powered by Hermes Agent and DeepSeek v4 · 2026

Case File Overview

62-HQ-83894 — opened July 1947 · 2,638 pages · 20 volumes · 153 visual pages

2,638

OCR Pages

20

Volumes

2,647

Page Images

153

Visual Pages

1947–68

Date Range

Five Phases of the Investigation

1. Initial Outbreak

Jul 1947

FBI creates file within days of Arnold sighting. Teletype traffic, A-2 coordination.

2. Active Investigation

Aug–Sep 1947

Bulletin 42 authorizes field offices to exhaustively interview witnesses.

3. Intelligence Deepening

Aug–Oct 1947

CONFIDENTIAL/SECRET military intel shared. Erratic flight characteristics documented.

4. Diminishing Tempo

Oct 1947–Jul 1949

Shift from "interview" to "refer to Air Forces." Handoff of primary responsibility.

5. Citizen Mail

Jul 1949–1968

File becomes repository for letters, clippings. Routine security screening. Passive archiving.

The 1947 Wave — FBI's Immediate Response

Section 1, Serials 1–52 · July 1947 · "Flying disc hysteria"

The File Opens

- FBI created 62-HQ-83894 within days of Kenneth Arnold's June 24, 1947 sighting over Mt. Rainier
- Immediate teletype traffic between FBI field offices and HQ — New Orleans, Detroit, San Francisco
- Director Hoover's inner circle directly involved: Tolson, Tamm, Ladd, Nichols on routing slips

Key Quote — Army Air Forces:

"Capt. Tom Brown... acknowledged that the Air Forces had decided 'there's something to this'"

— Reported by FBI, July 1947

This is the foundational document of official U.S. government UAP interest — the FBI file that launched two decades of records.

Early Incidents in the File

Priest finds disc (Grafton, WI):

- Rev. Joseph Brasky reports 18-inch metal disc
- Crashed in parish yard — later revealed as prank

Mass sightings — Portland, OR:

- Multiple police officers report discs
- United Airlines crew over Boise confirms
- Coastguardsman photos near Seattle

Anonymous warning letter:

- Citizen theorizes discs are European germ-warfare devices — taken seriously enough to be filed

Army Air Forces response:

- P-80 jets placed on standby
- Gen. Spaatz trip to Pacific Northwest
- Immediate A-2 intelligence liaison established

Military Intelligence Collaboration

FBI ↔ Army Air Forces A-2 · Lt. Col. Springer · Bulletin 42 · Classified sharing

The FBI-A-2 Partnership

- Central figure: Lt. Col. Donald L. Springer
A-2 Intelligence, Fourth Air Force, Hamilton Field
- Coordination established within days of file opening
- Weekly A-2 Intelligence Summaries forwarded to FBI
- Military documents classified CONFIDENTIAL/SECRET
shared through liaison channels

FBI Bulletin 42 (August 1947):

- Authorized field offices to "exhaustively interview" flying disc witnesses
- Directed agents to coordinate with Army/Navy
- Established formal evidence collection protocols
- Marked peak of active FBI UAP investigation

This was not passive monitoring — this was an active, coordinated intelligence operation.

Key Military Liaisons

Fourth Air Force A-2 (Hamilton Field, CA):

- Primary military intelligence partner
- Forwarded witness statements, investigation results
- Shared classified assessments with FBI

Army Air Forces Command:

- Gen. Curtis LeMay referenced in guided missile context
- Capt. Tom Brown: "there's something to this"
- P-80 interceptors placed on standby

FBI Field Office Network:

- SAC San Francisco: primary A-2 contact (DWK:MR)
- SAC Butte: investigated pre-Arnold prison warden sighting
- SAC San Antonio: monitored saucer convention planning

Takeaway: interagency coordination contradicts "never took this seriously."

Key Witness Accounts in the Case File

Independent corroboration · Pre-Arnold sightings · Military personnel witnesses

F.M. Johnson — Independent Arnold Corroborator

- Prospector from Portland, OR
- Saw same objects as Kenneth Arnold on June 24, 1947 from Mt. Adams district — same day, different location
- Described 30-ft round objects, "head end in oval shape"
- No noise, magnetic-like tail movement
- Wrote directly to Col. Springer at Fourth Air Force

Warden John Henry — Pre-Arnold Sighting

- Montana State Prison warden
- Saw silver object disintegrate on May 5, 1947 — 7 weeks BEFORE Kenneth Arnold
- With chauffeur Melbourne Hill and Mrs. Henry
- Object left "long pillar of gas" upon disintegration
- Reported retroactively after saucer publicity
- FBI Butte investigated despite time lapse

Guam Sighting — Military Personnel

- Three American enlisted men (147th Airways & Air Communications Service)
- Observed unidentified flying objects
- Excerpted from Air Transport Command Weekly Intelligence Summary
- Forwarded to FBI via military channels

Richmond Rankin — Portland Witness

- Provided confidential statement to FBI
- "I am of sound mind... firmly convinced that the articles I saw are actually some sort of flying machines"

Erratic Flight Characteristics Documented:

- Objects change direction at 90-degree angles
- Oscillate between full disc / half-moon / nothing
- These characteristics appear in military A-2 reports shared with the FBI in 1947

The Diminishing Investigation

1948–1949: From active inquiry to passive archiving

The Pivot — 1948

- Investigative posture shifts decisively:
1947: "Exhaustively interview witnesses"
1948: "Refer to Air Forces"
- FBI begins disengaging from active saucer work
- Primary responsibility handed to military intelligence
- Field offices instructed to forward inquiries to A-2

Why the Pivot?

- Air Forces had Project Sign/Grudge running — arguably the appropriate lead agency
- FBI's jurisdiction: domestic security, not aerial
- Resource allocation — saucer wave was receding
- Institutional discomfort with unexplained phenomena

But: the pivot happened despite A-2 having confirmed "there's something to this."

The Citizen Mail Era — 1949–1968

- File essentially becomes a repository for:
 - Citizen letters (typed and handwritten)
 - Newspaper clippings about saucers
 - Occasional new sighting reports
- Routine security screening applied to ALL saucer correspondents — FBI Search Slips checking for subversive references
- Example: Walter D. Jones (Toronto farmer, 1950):
Reports hazy light object circling farm for 35 min with houseman corroboration. Closes letter:
"If you are not interested throw it in the waste paper basket"
- FBI Search Slip run on Jones: checks for subversive references in Canada

The file becomes a record of what citizens reported — not what the FBI investigated.

Media & Public Management

Cuneo-Winchell channel · Saucer convention monitoring · Institutional disengagement

The Cuneo-Winchell Media Channel (July 1949)

- Ernest Cuneo — journalist/attorney, persistent intermediary between media and FBI
- Called FBI Director's office twice (July 11–12, 1949)
- Spoke directly to D.M. Ladd about releasing a saucer story from California
- **Ladd's response: "this was up to him"**
 - FBI washing hands of media management
- Walter Winchell referenced in saucer story context

This exchange reveals the FBI's deliberate disengagement: they would neither confirm, deny, nor manage public saucer narratives. "Up to him" = institutional washing of hands.

Saucer Convention Monitoring

- Young Men's Business Club (Alexandria, LA, Jul 1949): Planned national convention for flying saucer witnesses — tracked by Army G-2 and FBI
- FBI San Antonio and Alexandria field offices actively monitored convention planning
- Galveston TX newspaper report (Jul 10, 1949): flying saucer convention announcement triggers G-2/FBI monitoring

The Security Screening Pattern:

- Every saucer correspondent — farmer, priest, business owner — checked for subversive links
- FBI Search Slips (Service Unit 4-22a) run routinely
- UAP interest treated as potential security concern

Implication: the FBI viewed public UAP interest as a security matter, not a scientific one.

Vision Regrade: Specimens vs Photos

GPT-5.5 review · 153 visual pages · strongest finding is archival, not optical proof



Section 3 p25 — CONFIDENTIAL specimen photographs

High archival significance: physical fragments were photographed and filed. Composition, origin, chain-of-custody, and disposition remain unknown.

WHAT CHANGED AFTER DIRECT VISION

UPGRADED — Section 3 specimens:

- Real photographed fragments/specimens under CONFIDENTIAL markings
- Best Track D visual finding, but not material identification

DATIL NM / LaPaz page:

- Historically significant typed analysis by Dr. Lincoln LaPaz
- Photo itself is visually weak: a small luminous dot in a dark field

DOWNGRADED — dramatic saucer images:

- Mostly newspaper, magazine, or saucer-club reproductions
- Useful for UFO culture history, not controlled FBI photo proof

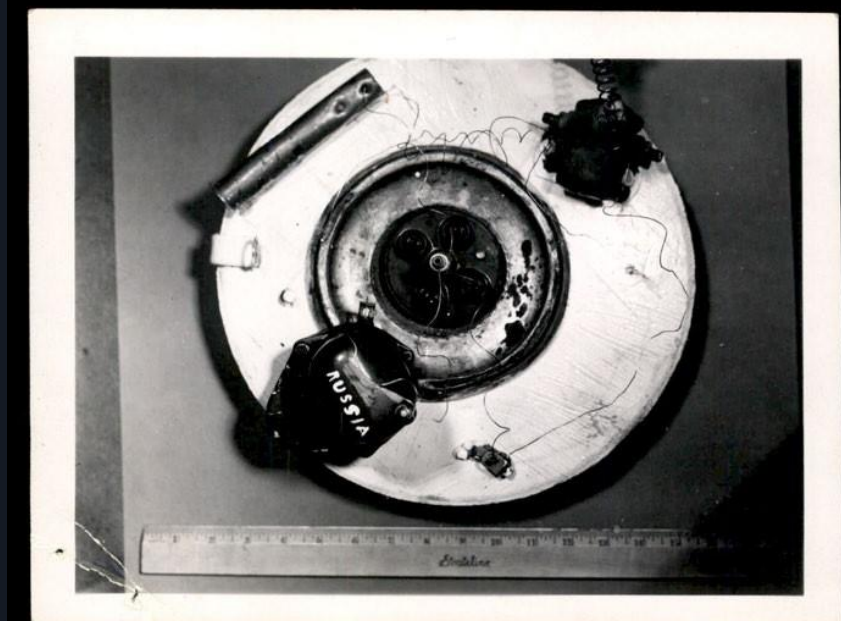
LOW CONFIDENCE — residential bright object:

- Ambiguous: could be lamp, reflection, lens flare, defect, or damage

Revised frame: Track D is an evidence ecosystem — specimens, photos, sketches, hoaxes, devices, press, and civilian UFO culture.

Device, Sketches & Speculative Designs

Witness perception · photographed device · international public submissions



Section 2 p85 — circular device with ruler, wiring, probable “RUSSIA” marking

Open question: model, component, foreign-tech assessment, or unrelated exhibit? The file does not resolve function or provenance.

PHOTOGRAPHED DEVICE SERIES

- 11 consecutive pages show a circular mechanical/electrical assembly
- Ruler/scale, wires, central rotor/fan-like component, circular base
- Probable “RUSSIA”/“RUSS...” marking is plausible but not certain

WITNESS SKETCHES

- Rev. John Miller sketches: clouds, “whirling wheels,” motion trails
- Useful for perception/history, not direct object identification

QUASI-TECHNICAL DIAGRAMS

- Twin Falls 10FT/20FT disc: newspaper illustration, not FBI engineering
- Argentine “cónica-global” submission: international speculative design

Interpretation rule:

Visual impact ≠ evidentiary strength. The file captures how claims were drawn, modeled, mailed, and archived.

Hoaxes, Police & Civilian UFO Culture

The FBI file preserved debunking, skepticism, and organized ufology



SUB_A p7 — R.O. Schmidt, Kearney Police Chief Nelson, and spaceship diagram

PUBLIC CLAIMS + OFFICIAL SKEPTICISM

Schmidt / Kearney police article:

- “Space-Ship Story Raises Eyebrows” combines witness claim, police questioning, and craft diagram
- Strong visual panel because it shows public folklore entering the FBI file

Saw blade hoax:

- Man holding circular saw blade preserved beside debunking headline
- Shows FBI file includes mundane explanations, not just sensational claims

AFSCA / saucer-club material:

- Convention and organized civilian UFO pages were retained in the case file
- Raises surveillance vs passive-archiving question

Publication saucer photos:

- Visually dramatic but weak provenance — treat as UFO-culture evidence, not FBI-controlled photographic proof

Best reading: Track D documents the whole evidence ecosystem — claims, photos, hoaxes, police, press, and organized believers.

Conclusions & Open Questions

What We Now Know

- ✓ FBI created 62-HQ-83894 within days of Kenneth Arnold — not weeks or months later
- ✓ A-2 coordination was immediate and sustained with Lt. Col. Springer as the key liaison
- ✓ Capt. Tom Brown told FBI the Air Forces had decided “there’s something to this”
- ✓ Bulletin 42 authorized exhaustive witness interviews — active intelligence work, not passive monitoring
- ✓ By 1948–49 the posture shifted to handoff/archive “interview” → “refer to Air Forces” → citizen mail
- ✓ GPT-5.5 vision confirms a visual evidence ecosystem specimens, device photos, sketches, hoaxes, press
- ✓ Strongest visual finding: CONFIDENTIAL specimens; dramatic saucer photos have weaker provenance

Open Questions

- ? What A-2 intelligence was shared with the FBI that remains classified or absent?
- ? What happened to the Section 3 specimens — lab report, chain-of-custody, location, disposition?
- ? What is the Section 2 circular device with ruler, wires, and probable “RUSSIA/RUSS...” marking?
- ? Do original negatives/prints exist for Datil NM or only these degraded scans/reproductions?
- ? Why retain saucer-club and AFSCA materials — passive filing, monitoring, or security concern?
- ? Does the file continue beyond 1968 elsewhere? Different class, serial system, or archive?

Data Sources — Track D Files

20 volumes · 2,638 OCR pages · 2,647 extracted page images · 153 visual pages

Section 1 (Serials 1–52)

185 pp — Jul 1947 · Initial outbreak, teletypes, Arnold, A-2 liaison

Section 2 (Serials 53–100)

194 pp — Aug–Sep 1947 · Bulletin 42, active field work, device photos

Section 3 (Serials 101–130)

190 pp — A-2 sharing, Johnson corroboration, CONFIDENTIAL specimens

Section 4 (Serials 131–185)

214 pp — Oct 1947–Jul 1949 · diminishing tempo, handoff to Air Forces

Section 5 (Serials 186–245)

209 pp — Jul 1949–Sep 1950 · citizen mail, Cuneo channel, conventions

Sections 6–10 (Serials 246–844+)

1,167 pp — 1950s–1968 · Datil/LaPaz, clippings, passive archiving

SUB_A + Individual Serials

479 pp — serials 130, 153, 164, 220, 403, 438, 449 + SUB_A

Vision Review Packet

2,647 page images · 153 visual pages · GPT-5.5 contact sheets + individual reviews